

Gigabyte launched the Gigabyte 100 Series G1™ gaming motherboards, featuring the world's first audio onboard design that includes the Creative® Sound Core3D™ Quad-Core Audio Processor and Burr-Brown High End 127 dB DAC; and the Killer DoubleShot-X3™ Pro.

Gaming companies all over the world are busy keeping a close eye on India. ASUS sells gaming products under its brand called the Republic of Gamers, aka ROG, which in itself is considered a benchmark among the gaming community, has lined up some launches later this year targeted at entry-level gamers. Mr. Su elaborates, "We have the strongest gaming portfolio in all segments, from entry level gaming, hard-core to professional gaming. We want to continue expanding our portfolio. Our experience for the ROG series has been phenomenal to date and has constantly encouraged us to deliver on fulfilling the gaming requisites of all our existing and prospective customers."



BenQ will be launching two new gaming monitors soon. Says Mr. Singh, "The first is the XL2420G, our 144 Hz refresh rate gaming monitor with NVIDIA G sync support. This will retail at Rs 49000. The second model is the 27-inch RL series gaming monitor, the RL2755HM. This will retail at Rs 29,000."

Game to fame:

For a long time, gaming was not taken seriously in India. At best, it was considered an expensive hobby and frivolous. But things are changing since gaming is a burgeoning industry. Today, avid gamers and game developers in India don't raise as many eyebrows as would have been the case a decade ago. Mr. Grewal says, "You can see a lot of gaming teams coming up, who spend a lot of time practicing and polishing their skills, especially on the eve of a gaming contest."

This brings forth a big opportunity to component vendors like us as the growing gaming community is making a beeline for sophisticated gaming rigs." Mr. Grewal is alluding to competitions like the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup that are making the gaming arena in India vibrant and exciting.

Gaming on the right track:

Globally, gaming has now moved on from a leisure activity to a high-octane spectator sport with tech giants pumping in serious money. In India, however, some feel that competitive gaming still has a long way to go before it becomes an eSport. Says Mr. Grewal, "In countries like Korea, gaming is considered as a major sport and also a lucrative profession. In many countries, winners and successful players are treated as celebrities with a fan following that can make even film stars envious. India has to go a long way in gaming, but we have made a good start. Many of the cyber cafes have improved themselves into gaming cafes. These are frequented by gamers who are really passionate about eSports. Gone are the days when casual gamers used to flock around cyber cafes, and wait for their turn."

All said and done, the gaming industry in India is growing and experts say there is a big value chain that will support its growth. "Vendors and manufacturers of gaming products are investing hugely in marketing activities to create demand for their products. These include gaming experience zones, branding, and advertising among others. They are supporting and organising gaming events, and also giving technology and monetary assistance to gamers," states Mr. Grewal.

So, if you are a passionate gamer in India who loves to put your best combat technique forward, this is the time to be here. As Mr. Su points out, the industry is on the right track, "Growth projections look even better, with the gaming market in India pegged to reach Rs. 4,000 crore by the end of 2017."



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